

USC Upstate's "Reach Great Heights" campaign is designed to attract new students while encouraging new and current students to achieve their goals and pursue their passions. To spread the word about this campaign, a combination of Public relations, marketing, and advertising strategies must be employed.

1. Public Relations Strategies:

Public relations focuses on building and maintaining a positive image while fostering relationships with stakeholders. In this case, this includes students, faculty, staff, alumni, and the community. Public relations efforts include press releases, event planning, media relations, and crisis management. Public relations strategies differ from marketing and advertising because their primary goal is to enhance Upstate's reputation rather than drive sales or awareness about a specific product or service. While marketing and advertising focus on targeted messaging, Public relations focuses on shaping perceptions over time.

Why USC Upstate Should Dedicate Funds to Public Relations:

Investing in public relations is crucial to the campaign's success because it will help create trust and credibility for the university. Even if the university is already spending money on marketing and advertising, public relations efforts are necessary for long-term relationship building and ensuring that the university's reputation aligns with the brand messaging that marketing and advertising are putting out. Strong public relations strategies can also help to mitigate any future potential crises or negative press.

2. Marketing Strategies:

Marketing strategies include promoting USC Upstate's offerings, such as student services, campus life, or degree programs. They promote these offerings to specific audiences through research and promotions. Marketing uses various tactics like digital marketing, email campaigns, and content marketing. Marketing differs from public relations as it's more focused on driving engagement and conversations, and has measurable results. Public relations is about reputation management, while marketing is about positioning the university's services to the right audiences and encouraging some sort of action, such as participation in events or enrollment.

Why USC Upstate Should Dedicate Funds to Marketing:

While public relations focuses on the university's image, marketing is tied directly to results, for example, application numbers, event attendance, or donations. These efforts create direct interaction with potential stakeholders, ensuring that the university stays competitive. Without dedicated funds for marketing, USC Upstate might miss out on opportunities to engage with its audiences effectively.

3. Advertising Strategies:

Advertising strategies involve paid efforts to promote USC Upstate's programs, events, services, etc., through channels like digital ads, print ads, social media campaigns, or billboards. Unlike public relations and marketing, advertising is a much more direct and paid effort at reaching a much broader audience with specific calls to action. Advertising differs from marketing and public relations with its use of paid media to reach wider audiences while pushing a clear message. While marketing can include paid efforts, advertising focuses purely on the investment of funds for visibility and response.

Why USC Upstate Should Dedicate Funds to Advertising:

Advertising is essential for reaching large, specific groups directly and quickly, which ensures high visibility for the "Reach Greater Heights" campaign. It's especially important for promoting upcoming events, deadlines, and other time-sensitive information. By investing in advertising, USC Upstate can make sure that its message is visible to the right audiences at the right times.